CISCO SECURE · HMF DESIGN CLINIC · FACILITATOR

Grading Guide

Score three dimensions per pain point, 400 points in total

Score every pain point on three dimensions: 🔍 Problem Identifier out of 5, 🏗️ Solution Designer out of 10, and 🎯 Value Communicator out of 10. That is 25 per pain point, 100 per case study, and 400 for the clinic. Use the Solution Guide for the model answers.

HOW TO SCORE

The three dimensions

🔍 Problem Identifier / 5	🏗️ Solution Designer / 10	🎯 Value Communicator / 10
Correctly identified the customer's pain point and the requirements behind it.	Recommended the right Cisco solution, architecture, and approach.	Clearly explained how the solution works and the customer outcomes it enables.

Award the points

🔍 Problem Identifier	score 0 to 5
5	Precisely identifies the pain point and the requirements or constraints behind it.
3 to 4	Identifies the pain point but misses some requirements or nuance.
1 to 2	Vague or partial understanding of the concern.
0	Misreads the concern, or leaves it blank.

🏗️ Solution Designer	score 0 to 10
8 to 10	Recommends the right Cisco solution and an architecture or approach that fits Cedarline and the HMF design.
5 to 7	Right solution, but light on the architecture or approach.
2 to 4	Partly right, or a product named with no approach.
0 to 1	Wrong solution, or left blank.

🎯 Value Communicator	score 0 to 10
8 to 10	Clearly explains how the solution works and the concrete Cedarline outcomes it enables.
5 to 7	Explains how it works but is thin on outcomes, or states outcomes without the how.
2 to 4	Vague or generic.
0 to 1	No explanation, or left blank.

The maths. Problem Identifier (5) plus Solution Designer (10) plus Value Communicator (10) is **25 per pain point**. Four pain points is **100 per case study**. Four case studies is **400 in total**. Grade against the Solution Guide, and reward reasoning that is specific to Cedarline over generic best practice.

1

CASE STUDY 1 · SCORING

AI Security

PAIN POINT	🔍 PI /5	🏗️ SD /10	🎯 VC /10	TOTAL /25
1. Under the EU AI Act, we are classified as a 'Provider' for our internal AI systems. We need…	____	____	____	____
2. We are integrating various open-source models and third-party agents into our internal…	____	____	____	____
3. We know AI is showing up across our cloud environments faster than security can track it.…	____	____	____	____
4. We're running AI workloads in cloud accounts, but we don't have a reliable way to see which…	____	____	____	____
Case Study 1 total	____	____	____	____ / 100

Strengths and coaching for this case study

2

CASE STUDY 2 · SCORING

Cloud Edge

PAIN POINT	🔍 PI /5	🏗️ SD /10	🎯 VC /10	TOTAL /25
1. If a breach occurs in one of our public cloud instances, we are terrified that the attacker…	____	____	____	____
2. Our auditors require proof that our security controls are applied consistently across all our…	____	____	____	____
3. We have workloads spread across AWS, Azure, and on-premises data centers. Managing security…	____	____	____	____
4. We have workloads on-prem, in cloud, and in mixed environments, and policy consistency is…	____	____	____	____
Case Study 2 total	____	____	____	____ / 100

Strengths and coaching for this case study

3

CASE STUDY 3 · SCORING

DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall

PAIN POINT	🔍 PI /5	🏗️ SD /10	🎯 VC /10	TOTAL /25
1. When our security tools detect a compromised device, our manual response time is too slow. By…	______	______	______	______
2. Our firewall environment has become too complex to manage manually.	______	______	______	______
3. Most of our traffic is encrypted, so we've lost visibility into a huge part of our environment.	______	______	______	______
4. We're worried traditional signature-based detection won't catch new or unknown attacks…	______	______	______	______
Case Study 3 total	______	______	______	______ / 100

Strestrengths and coaching for this case study

4

CASE STUDY 4 · SCORING

Macro & Micro Segmentation

PAIN POINT	🔍 PI /5	🏗️ SD /10	🎯 VC /10	TOTAL /25
1. Network policy helps, but we also need to know what's happening at runtime inside the…	____	____	____	____
2. Our Kubernetes networking feels fragmented across clusters and environments. We're dealing…	____	____	____	____
3. Right now we're stitching together separate tools for networking, security, and observability…	____	____	____	____
4. We know we need microsegmentation, but we don't have enough visibility into east-west flows…	____	____	____	____
Case Study 4 total	____	____	____	____ / 100

Strengths and coaching for this case study

SCORE SUMMARY

Team total

Team ______________________________ **Event** _______________

CASE STUDY	🔍 PI /20	🏗️ SD /40	🎯 VC /40	TOTAL /100
1. AI Security				
2. Cloud Edge				
3. DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall				
4. Macro & Micro Segmentation				
Overall total				/ 400

Per case study each dimension totals four pain points: Problem Identifier out of 20, Solution Designer out of 40, Value Communicator out of 40.

Overall feedback

Strengths across the clinic

Priorities to develop